HANOVER RESEARCH

ACADEMIC PROGRAM ASSESSMENT

Bachelor's of Science In Public Health

Prepared for Texas Christian University (TCU)

June 2025

In the following report, Hanover Research (Hanover) assesses demand for bachelor's degree programs in public health, specifically highlighting demand trends within the state and across the nation. This report includes an examination of student and labor market demand, and an analysis of potential competitor programs.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

3 / Executive Summary

6 / Student Demand Analysis

8 / Labor Market Demand Analysis

11 / Accreditation Information

14 / Competitor Analysis

18 / Program Benchmarking

22 / Appendix

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

RECOMMENDATIONS

Based on an analysis of degree completions, labor market demand, and market competitors, Hanover recommends that Texas Christian University (TCU):

PROCEED WITH THE DEVELOPMENT OF A BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN PUBLIC HEALTH

Texas Christian University (TCU) should move forward with developing a Bachelor of Science in Public Health program. The demand for public health programs is growing, as evidenced by increasing degree completions in Texas, the Southwest region, and the nation across public and private institutions. Undergraduate conferrals in public health are growing faster than other programs and the field has a higher overall volume of degree completions. This program will prepare students for a variety of roles in the public health sector, and labor market projections for graduates working in this field are strong. This robust job market, coupled with consistent student demand, represents market conditions supportive of launching this program.

ESTABLISH AN ACCELERATED PATHWAY FOR STUDENTS TO COMPLETE AN MPH

A review of private institutions with exemplary bachelor's programs in public health reveals that most also offer a Master of Public Health (MPH) degree. Additionally, the majority of benchmarked institutions offer accelerated pathways for students to complete a bachelor's and master's program in public health in a reduced timeframe. Previous research conducted by Hanover for TCU supports the development of an MPH program. If TCU proceeds with developing both bachelor's and master's programs in this field, it should include a 4+1 option for students interested in obtaining both degrees.

CONSIDER INCLUDING CONCENTRATIONS

Four of ten reviewed exemplar bachelor's programs include designated concentrations or tracks for students. Three programs include concentrations related to specific content areas or subdisciplines of public health, while one institution has tracks for students with aspirations of attending medical school. Given that concentrations are not present in the majority of reviewed programs, they are likely not requisite for a successful program. However, they may serve as a differentiator to help set apart a newly launched program. The largest competitor program among private institutions in Texas, Baylor University's BS in Public Health, does not include concentrations. Aligning concentrations with career paths can also serve as a way to meet regional labor market needs and promote the value of the program.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

KEY FINDINGS

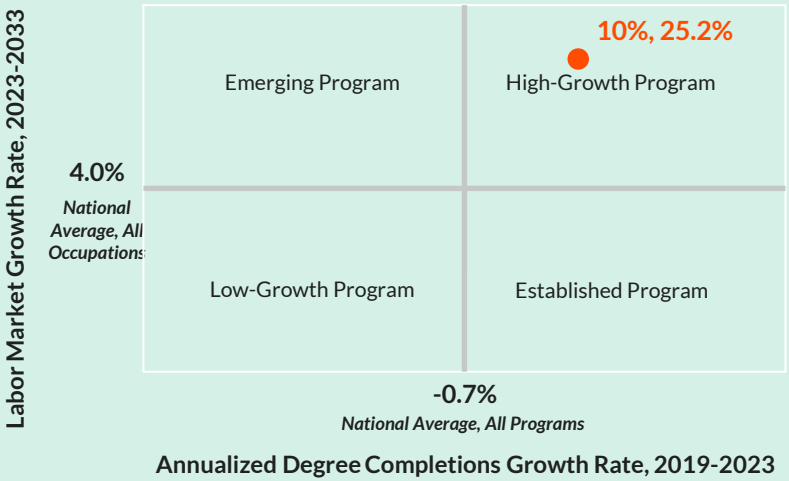
- **Student demand for bachelor's degrees in public health is strong.** In Texas, demand grew by 15.4 percent annually from 2019 to 2023. Degree completions regionally and nationally also outpaced average growth rates. This field also experienced an above average volume of conferrals. While conferrals reported by private not-for-profit institutions make up less than one-fifth of overall degree completions for this field, demand among private institutions is still increasing at an above average rate across geographies. This indicates robust student interest in public health programs.

- **The labor market for public health professionals is expected to be favorable over the next decade.** In Texas, employment for related occupations is projected to grow by 37.2 percent, surpassing the 13.8 percent growth rate across all occupations. National and regional projections are similarly strong. This growth in employment opportunities provides ample prospects for students to find employment after graduation, driven by factors such as the aging population and the increasing use of electronic health records.

- **Institutions with exemplary bachelor's level public health programs typically are CEPH accredited and offer a Master of Public Health (MPH) program.** Among reviewed programs with strong demand metrics, six of 10 reviewed bachelor's programs are accredited by the Council on Education for Public Health and eight of ten institutions offer an MPH. Further, six of these eight institutions offer an accelerated pathway that allows students to complete both a bachelor's and master's public health program on an expedited timeline (generally in five years).

NATIONAL BENCHMARK ANALYSIS

Comparison of [degree program] completions and relevant labor market to all completions and all occupations in the [state, region, or country]



FAST FACTS

1,122 Total number of public health bachelor's degrees conferred in Texas in 2023.

37.2% Projected employment growth rate of related occupations in Texas through 2034.

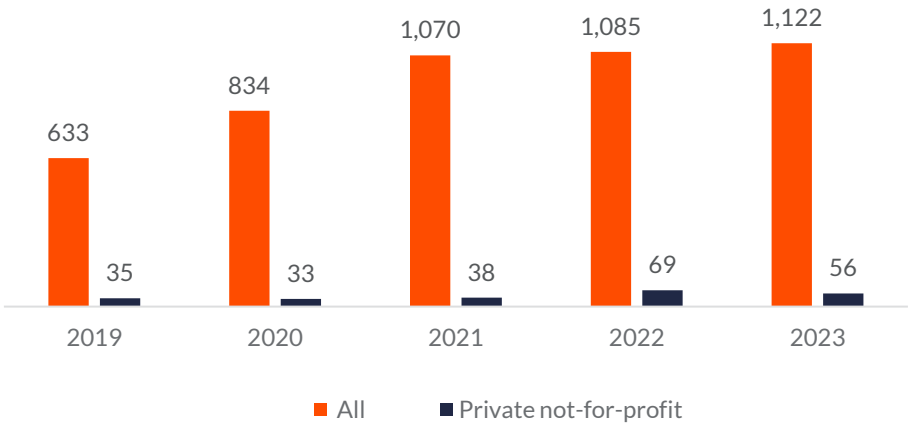
868,967 Volume of regional job postings over the past year for public health occupations.

STUDENT DEMAND ANALYSIS

STUDENT DEMAND ANALYSIS

STATE LEVEL DEGREE COMPLETIONS

Texas distribution of degree completions from 2019-2023



TOTAL DEGREE COMPLETIONS

Aggregate degree completions by geographic level (2023)

	Texas	Southwest	National
Conferrals for Public Health, General.	1,122	1,694	11,149
Conferrals for Public Health, General. **– Private Institutions**	**56**	**56**	**1,873**
Growth Rate for Public Health, General.	**15.4%**	**9.9%**	**10.0%**
Growth Rate for Public Health, General. – **Private Institutions**	**12.5%**	**12.5%**	**5.8%**
Growth Rate, All Fields	**0.1%**	**0.6%**	**-0.7%**

ANALYSIS

Student demand indicators for bachelor's of science in public health programs are positive across geographies. In Texas, student demand grew by 15.4 percent annually from 2019 to 2023, compared to 9.9 percent regionally and 10 percent nationally—each exceeding the respective growth rates across all bachelor's degree fields. This indicates a robust and above-average interest in public health. Conferral volume for public health bachelor's degrees is also higher than the average amount across all bachelor's fields at each geographic level, further indicating strong student demand.

Student demand among private institutions has also experienced growth. Across geographies, degree completions in public health at private (not-for-profit) institutions have increased at a rate outpacing average growth across all bachelor's fields. In the nation, conferrals reported by private institutions make up about 17 percent of all public health degree completions. Throughout the Southwest region, the only private institutions reporting degree completions are located in Texas, with the largest private competitor by volume being Baylor University, which reported 31 conferrals in 2023.

The rise in undergraduate public health majors is likely related to the COVID-19 pandemic and increased awareness of systemic health disparities among American youth. In the United States, bachelor's degrees in public health are growing at a faster rate than master's programs and have a relatively similar volume of degree completions. While some undergraduate students that major in public health may ultimately go on to work in other industries, scholars note that having professionals educated in public health across sectors ultimately benefits public health and safety overall.

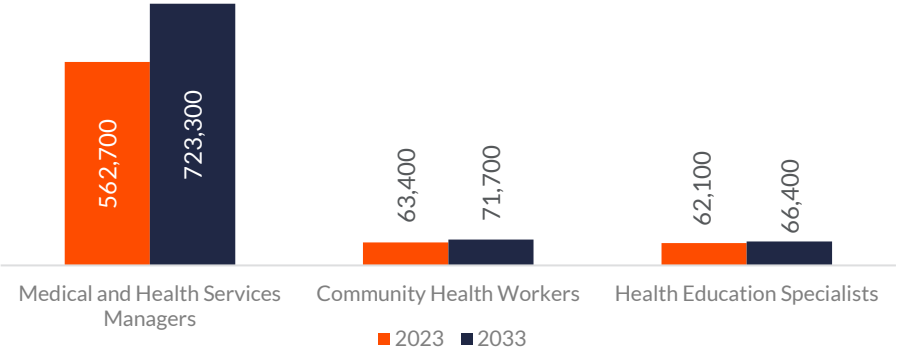
Source: IPEDS

LABOR DEMAND ANALYSIS

LABOR MARKET ANALYSIS

NATIONAL LEVEL CURRENT AND PROJECTED EMPLOYMENT

National Level Bachelor's of Science in Public Health positions as of 2023 and 2033 (projected)



TOTAL LABOR MARKET

Aggregate projected employment growth by geographic level

	Texas	Southwest	National
Estimated Employment	63,737	90,469	688,200
Projected Employment	87,437	122,369	861,400
Total Annual Openings, Observed Occupations	**7,895**	**11,024**	**75,600**
Employment Growth, Observed Occupations	**37.2%**	**35.3%**	**25.2%**
Employment Growth, All Occupations	**13.8%**	**12.3%**	**4.0%**

ANALYSIS

At the state, regional, and national levels, graduates of BS in Public Health programs are likely to encounter a favorable job market. In Texas, employment for related occupations is expected to grow by 37.2 percent over the next decade, outpacing the 13.8 percent growth rate across all occupations. Regionally, related fields are projected to grow by 35.3 percent, surpassing the 12.3 percent growth rate across all occupations. Nationally, the growth forecast for related fields is 25.2 percent, well above the 4.0 percent growth rate for all fields.

Among relevant occupations, *Medical and Health Services Managers* are expected to experience the highest national growth over the next decade. The BLS job outlook predicts a 29 percent increase in employment for these professionals from 2023 to 2033, significantly outpacing the average for all occupations. This growth translates to approximately 61,400 job openings annually, driven by the need to replace retiring workers and those transitioning to other roles.

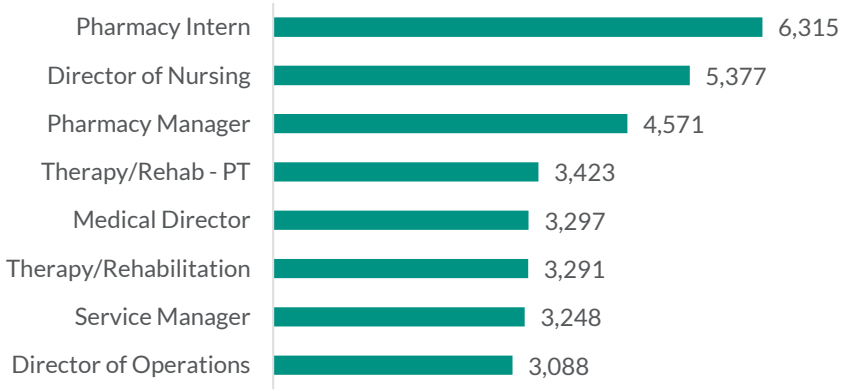
The aging baby-boom population and the increasing use of electronic health records will further amplify the demand for skilled managers. The integration of electronic health records underscores the need for managers proficient in health information technology and informatics. This demand is also fueled by the complexity and expansion of healthcare facilities, necessitating skilled managers to oversee operations, compliance, and cost control. The industry is notably concentrated in states like California, New York, and Texas, reflecting regional healthcare needs and employment opportunities.

Sources: JobsEQ and BLS
Note: State and regional employment data come from JobsEQ and reflect the period from 2024 to 2034, whereas national data come from the BLS and reflect the period from 2023 to 2033.

REAL-TIME JOB POSTINGS INTELLIGENCE

TOP PUBLIC HEALTH-RELATED JOB TITLES

National Public Health-related positions by job title



TOP CREDENTIALS AND SKILLS

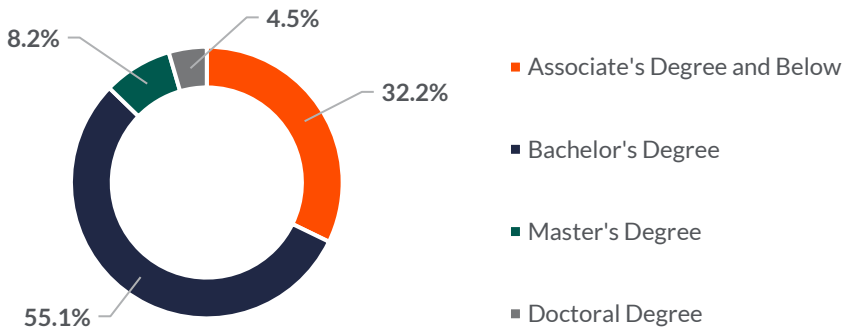
Certifications	Hard Skills
• Registered Nurse (RN) • Advanced Cardiac Life Support Certification (ACLS) • Licensed Practical Nurse (LPN) • Pediatric Advanced Life Support (PALS) • Licensed Clinical Social Worker (LCSW) • Project Management Professional (PMP)	• Long-Term Care • Home Health Care • Medical Terminology • Electronic Health Record (EHR) • Spanish • Patient Care

Note: Hanover used a targeted search for collecting data from JobsEQ, a proprietary database providing real-time job postings aggregated from thousands of websites. The following filters were applied: National (country); past 12 months as of May 2025 (time frame); Medical and Health Services Managers, Community Health Workers, Health Education Specialists (occupations); excluding staffing companies (company type).

ANALYSIS

In the past 12 months, over 100,000 employers across the nation posted over 800,000 job ads related to public health professions. Of job ads that specify a minimum education level, 8.2 percent of relevant job ads specifically require a master's degree, while the majority require a bachelor's degree (55.1 percent) or lower credential.

EDUCATION REQUIREMENTS



TOP NATIONAL EMPLOYERS

CVS (18,554)	Walmart (5,747)	Trinity Health (4,677)
Department of Veterans Affairs (14,986)	Access Healthcare LLC (5,710)	Elevance Health (4,126)
UnitedHealth Group (6,595)	Adventist Health (4,942)	HCA Healthcare (4,037)

ACCREDITATION INFORMATION

ACCREDITATION – GENERAL OVERVIEW

ACCREDITATION OVERVIEW

CEPH Accreditation requires a multi-step process primarily centered around a written plan that must undergo several drafts and rounds of edits.

The Council on Education for Public Health (CEPH) began accrediting schools of public health in 1974 and is an independent accrediting body established by the American Public Health Association (APHA) and the Association of Schools and Programs of Public Health (ASPPH). Initial accreditation is typically granted for periods of five years and reaccreditation decisions are typically made for seven years at a time.

REQUIRED COMPONENTS OF APPLICATION

- Statement of Understanding
- Statement of Regional Accreditation
- Guiding Statements and Evaluation Practices
- Instructional Matrix
- Foundational Curriculum Mapping
- Concentration Curriculum Mapping
- Projected Student Enrollment
- Required Faculty Resources
- Graduation Data
- Institutional Commitment & Fiscal Support
- Course Syllabi
- Primary Instructional Faculty

ACCREDITATION TIMELINE

1. Contact CEPH Director of Accreditation Services and develop accreditation timeline
2. Participate in CEPH's Pre-Application Orientation Webinar
3. Submit payment for the initial application submission fee
4. Submit a first draft of the Initial Application Submission (IAS) for CEPH review using templates available on the CEPH website
5. Receive staff feedback on the draft IAS
6. Revise IAS in response to staff feedback (may take several drafts)
7. Officially submit the IAS and appendices for review
8. Receive official notification of Council decision
9. Pay applicant fee
10. Receive site visitors approximately 18 months before the arranged self-study due date from the IAS report

Source: CEPH

CEPH ACCREDITATION – BACHELOR'S IN PUBLIC HEALTH

CEPH ACCREDITATION

CEPH accredits public health programs, schools of public health, and standalone bachelor's degrees. CEPH accreditation is considered a mark of quality for public health programs.

Accreditation is beneficial to an institution because it "serves as a reliable basis for inter- and intra-institutional cooperative practices, including admissions and transfer of credit" as well as "enhances its national reputation and represents peer recognition." Overall, acquiring CEPH accreditation allows program graduates to be more competitive on the labor market and increases the prestige of the program by signaling that in meets the highest standard.

ACCREDITATION COSTS

Initial Application Submission Fee	▪ $1,000
Applicant Fee	▪ $3500 for schools of public health ▪ $2500 for public health programs (PHP or SBP)
Accreditation Review Fee	▪ $4000 for schools of public health ▪ $3000 for public health programs
Annual Support Fee	▪ Ranges from $4,794 to $9,586 depending on the program(s)

Source: CEPH
Note: Accreditation information is copied verbatim or near verbatim. For a complete list of accreditation procedures and criteria, please refer to the source.

ACCREDITATION PROCESS

The accreditation process is lengthy and often takes three years. For information on accreditation criteria see the CEPH website. Below is a condensed version of the accreditation process.

Pre-Application and Application
- Contact CEPH director
- Submit Initial Application Submission and revised submissions
- Schedule site visit

Self-Study Process
- Submit preliminary self-study/ receive CEPH feedback
- Incorporate feedback
- Send final self-study to all members of site visit team

Site Visit & Accreditation Decision
- Host two-day site visit
- Receive draft report/ prepare response to draft report
- Council receives updated report
- Council makes an accreditation decision

Post-Council Decision
- Council's decision informs any additional reporting that may be needed
- Interim reports address non-compliant findings

Reaccreditation
- The council grants initial accreditation for five years
- A site visit will be planned prior to expiration of term

COMPETITOR ANALYSIS

COMPETITOR ANALYSIS

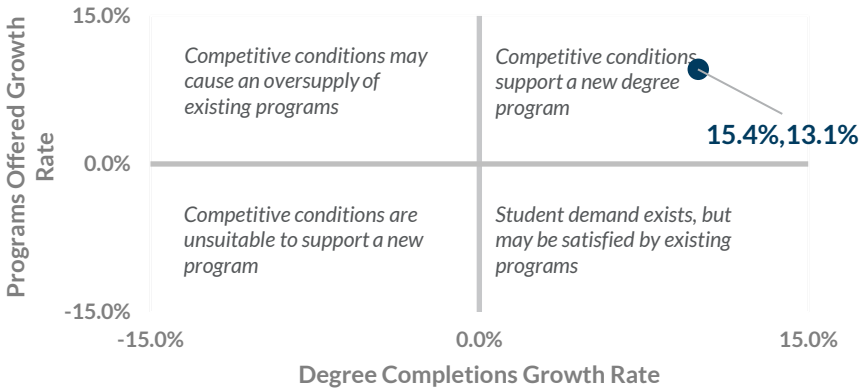
ANALYSIS

The competitive landscape supports the creation of a new bachelor of science in public health program in Texas. From 2019 to 2023, the number of degree completions in public health bachelor's programs increased by 15.4 percent annually, while the number of offered programs grew by 13.1 percent. This suggests that student demand is growing at a similar pace as the number of programs, indicating that public health programs are performing well and competitive conditions are supportive.

To help TCU better understand the competitive landscape, Hanover conducted a benchmarking analysis of ten undergraduate public health programs. Hanover prioritized private institutions in the nation with above average growth and volume in degree completions. Baylor University was included upon client request. A complete list of public and private institutions reporting undergraduate public health programs in the state of Texas and in the Dallas/Fort Worth/Arlington metro area is included in the appendix.

STATE LEVEL MARKET SATURATION

Within Texas do competitive conditions support an additional bachelor's in public health program?



BENCHMARKED PROGRAMS

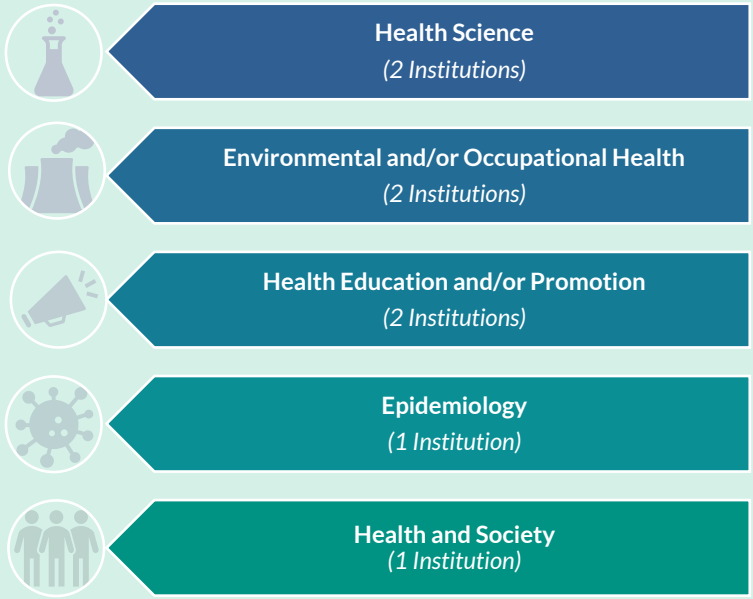
Institution	Program	Location	2023 Conferrals	2019-2023 CAGR
Baylor University	Bachelor of Science in Public Health	Waco, Texas	31	--
Brigham Young University	Bachelor of Science in Public Health	Provo, Utah	65	15.1%
California Baptist University	Bachelor of Science in Public Health	Riverside, California	38	2.1%
Drexel University	Bachelor of Science in Public Health	Philadelphia, Pennsylvania	29	16.0%
Johns Hopkins University	Bachelor of Arts in Public Health	Baltimore, Maryland	177	1.8%
Mercer University	Bachelor of Science in Public Health	Macon, Georgia	36	18.9%
Pacific University	Bachelor of Science in Public Health	Grove, Oregon	29	7.2%
Saint Louis University	Bachelor of Science in Public Health	St. Louis, Missouri	54	5.3%
Santa Clara University	Bachelor of Science in Public Health	Santa Clara, California	59	10.9%
Xavier University of Louisiana	Bachelor of Science in Public Health	New Orleans, Louisiana	45	31.6%

PROGRAM TRENDS

CONCENTRATIONS

Four of ten reviewed public health programs include designated concentrations or areas of emphasis. The number of concentration options ranges from two to four. California Baptist University (2), Saint Louis University (2), Santa Clara University (2), and Brigham Young University (4) each offer concentrations within their undergraduate public health programs. Typically, concentrations are focused on a specific content area or subdiscipline, however, both tracks available at Saint Louis University are for designed for students planning to attend medical school following their undergraduate program.

CONCENTRATION AREAS

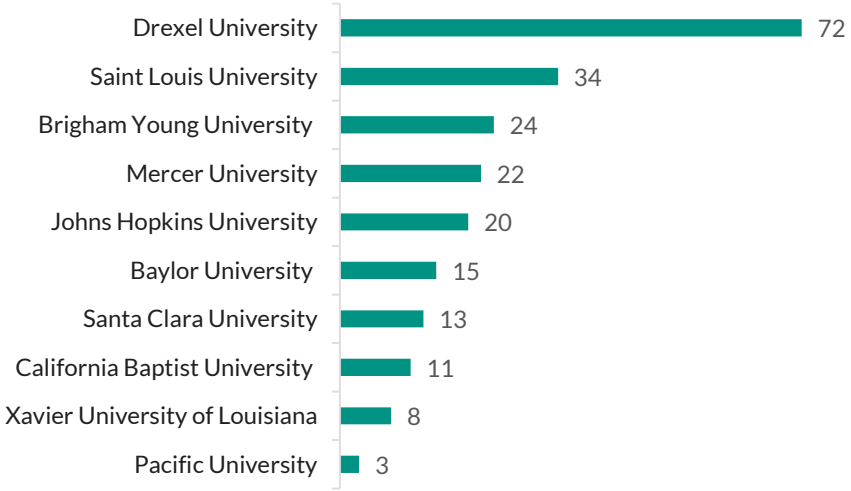


MAJOR CREDITS

On average, benchmarked programs require about 49 major credits. For several programs, the number of major credits required varies slightly depending on which concentration students have selected. Drexel University requires the lowest number of major credits at 33. Santa Clara University, Brigham Young University, California Baptist University require the most major credits, ranging from 56 to 76.

FACULTY

The number of faculty associated with public health programs among benchmarked institutions varies greatly. Across reviewed universities, the number of identified public health faculty ranges from three at Pacific University to 72 at Drexel University. The average number of faculty members is 22 (and the median is 17.5).



PROGRAM TRENDS

MASTER OF PUBLIC HEALTH PROGRAMS

Eight of ten reviewed institutions offer a Master of Public Health (MPH) program in addition to the bachelor's program. Pacific University and Santa Clara University are the only reviewed institutions not offering an MPH program. Among institutions that offer both bachelor's and master's level public health programs, six of eight institutions offer an accelerated pathway for students to complete both a bachelor's and master's program in a shortened timeframe.

MPH and Accelerated Pathway Available

- Baylor University
- Brigham Young University
- Drexel University
- Johns Hopkins University
- Mercer University
- Saint Louis University

MPH Available (No Accelerated Pathway)

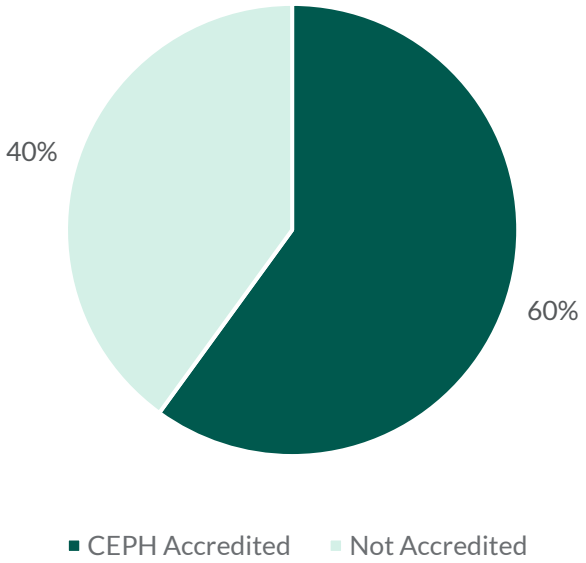
- California Baptist University
- Xavier University of Louisiana

No MPH Available

- Pacific University
- Santa Clara University

ACCREDITATION

Six of 10 reviewed bachelor's programs in public health are accredited by the Council on Education for Public Health (CEPH). Institutions whose undergraduate programs are not CEPH accredited exactly align with those that either do not offer an MPH program or offer an MPH program but do not have an accelerated bachelor's to master's option, suggesting that institutions with more robust public health programming are more likely to work towards accreditation.



PROGRAM BENCHMARKING

PROGRAM BENCHMARKING

Institution	Program	Major Credit Hours	Concentrations	Prescence of an MPH	Accreditation	Number of Faculty
Baylor University	**Bachelor of Science in Public Health**	50 Credits	--	▪ Offers both a residential and an online Master of Public Health (MPH) ▪ Offers an accelerated 5-year joint degree BSPH/MPH program	Accredited by CEPH	15 faculty members: ▪ 1 chair ▪ 4 professors ▪ 2 associate professors ▪ 5 assistant professors ▪ 1 clinical associate professor ▪ 1 clinical assistant professor ▪ 1 senior lecturer
Brigham Young University	**Bachelor of Science in Public Health**	57.5-60 Credits *(depending on emphasis)*	Emphases: ▪ Epidemiology ▪ Environmental and Occupational Health ▪ Health Promotion ▪ Health Science	▪ Offers a Master of Public Health ▪ Offers an Integrated Bachelor of Science/Master of Public Health program (4+1 program) – only available for students in the Health Promotion and Health Science emphases	Accredited by CEPH	24 faculty members: ▪ 7 professors ▪ 12 associate professors ▪ 3 assistant professor ▪ 2 adjunct faculty
California Baptist University	**Bachelor of Science in Public Health**	56-76 Credits *(depending on concentration)*	Concentrations: ▪ Environmental Health ▪ Health Education and Promotion	▪ Offers a Master of Public Health	Program does **not** appear to be accredited by CEPH (Institution's MPH program is accredited by CEPH)	11 faculty members: ▪ 4 professors ▪ 4 associate professors ▪ 2 assistant professors ▪ 1 clinical professor

Sources: Institutional websites (see embedded hyperlinks)
* Credits are converted from quarter credits to semester credits

PROGRAM BENCHMARKING

Institution	Program	Major Credit Hours	Concentrations	Prescence of an MPH	Accreditation	Number of Faculty
Drexel University	**Bachelor of Science in Public Health**	33 Credits*	--	▪ Offers a Master of Public Health ▪ Offers an accelerated (4+1) Bachelors of Science/Master of Public Health program	Accredited by CEPH	72 faculty members: ▪ 17 professors ▪ 15 associate professors ▪ 20 assistant professors ▪ 11 research faculty (incl. assistant, associate, professors) 11 teaching faculty (incl. assistant, associate, professors) 9 clinical faculty (incl. assistant, associate, professors)
Johns Hopkins University	**Bachelor of Arts in Public Health**	46 Credits	--	▪ Offers both a residential and online MPH program ▪ Offers multiple accelerated Bachelor's/MSPH programs	Accredited by CEPH	20 faculty members ▪ 1 program director ▪ 4 professors ▪ 3 associate professors ▪ 1 assistant professor ▪ 2 research faculty (incl. assistant and professor) ▪ 1 lecturer ▪ 1 senior associate ▪ 7 scientists and researchers
Mercer University	**Bachelor of Science in Public Health**	39 Credits	--	▪ Offers a Master of Public Health ▪ Offers an accelerated (5-year) special consideration program for Bachelor of Science in Public Health and Master of Public Health	Accredited by CEPH	22 faculty members ▪ 1 chair ▪ 2 professors ▪ 1 associate professor ▪ 1 professor of practice ▪ 2 associate professors of practice ▪ 2 assistant professors of practice ▪ 1 instructor ▪ 12 adjunct faculty

Sources: Institutional websites (see embedded hyperlinks)

PROGRAM BENCHMARKING

Institution	Program	Major Credit Hours	Concentrations	Prescence of an MPH	Accreditation	Number of Faculty
Pacific University	**Bachelor of Science in Public Health**	52-53 Credits	--	**No** MPH offered	**Not** accredited by CEPH	3 faculty members: ▪ 1 associate professor ▪ 2 assistant professors
Saint Louis University	**Bachelor of Science in Public Health**	36 Credits	Tracks: ▪ Pre-med track ▪ Medical Scholars Program track	▪ Offers a Master of Public Health ▪ Offers an accelerated (5-year) Bachelor of Science/Master of Public Health program	Accredited by CEPH	34 faculty members: ▪ 15 professors ▪ 11 associate professors ▪ 6 assistant professors ▪ 2 instructors *Includes all faculty for the College of Public Health and Social Justice*
Santa Clara University	**Bachelor of Science in Public Health**	64-67 Credits * (depending on emphasis)	Emphases: ▪ Health Science ▪ Health and Society	**No** MPH offered	**Not** accredited by CEPH	13 faculty members: ▪ 1 professor ▪ 2 associate professors ▪ 3 assistant professors ▪ 1 executive professor ▪ 6 lecturers
Xavier University of Louisiana	**Bachelor of Science in Public Health**	47 Credits	--	▪ Offers a Master of Public Health – in Health Equity	**Not** accredited by CEPH	8 faculty members: ▪ 1 endowed chair ▪ 2 associate professors ▪ 5 assistant professors

Sources: Institutional websites (see embedded hyperlinks)
*Credits estimated based on number of required courses. Credits are converted from quarter credits to semester credits.

APPENDIX

PUBLIC HEALTH BACHELOR'S PROGRAMS IN TEXAS

Institution	2023 Conferrals	Annualized Growth 2019-2023	Control	Geography
Texas A & M University-Commerce	26	14.7%	Public	**Dallas-Fort Worth-Arlington, TX**
Texas Woman's University	**0**	--	Public	**Dallas-Fort Worth-Arlington, TX**
The University of Texas at Arlington	237	73.8%	Public	**Dallas-Fort Worth-Arlington, TX**
The University of Texas at Dallas	**0**	--	Public	**Dallas-Fort Worth-Arlington, TX**
University of North Texas at Dallas	20	25.7%	Public	**Dallas-Fort Worth-Arlington, TX**
Austin College	19	-4.7%	**Private not-for-profit**	TX (remainder of state)
Baylor University	31	--	**Private not-for-profit**	TX (remainder of state)
East Texas Baptist University	1	--	**Private not-for-profit**	TX (remainder of state)
Schreiner University	5	-19.7%	**Private not-for-profit**	TX (remainder of state)
South University-Austin	4	7.5%	Private for-profit	TX (remainder of state)
Sam Houston State University	75	-11.6%	Public	TX (remainder of state)
Tarleton State University	11	21.8%	Public	TX (remainder of state)
Texas A & M International University	10	--	Public	TX (remainder of state)
Texas A & M University-College Station	244	20.7%	Public	TX (remainder of state)
Texas State University	49	--	Public	TX (remainder of state)
The University of Texas at Austin	168	11.7%	Public	TX (remainder of state)
The University of Texas at El Paso	34	--	Public	TX (remainder of state)
The University of Texas at San Antonio	188	-0.9%	Public	TX (remainder of state)

HANOVER RESEARCH

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